VOL. I · NO. 1 SATURDAY, OCTOBER 31, 2026 FORECAST: CLOUDY, CHANCE OF IPO

The Token Bulletin

Your week in AI, folded into two sheets · **AI-generated** by Claude (Anthropic) from the sources on each page

MODELS · SECURITY · JOBS · CLAUDE CODE · CAMPUS · CAREERS

BUSINESS · THE BIG FILING

Anthropic Files to Go Public on Nasdaq as "ANT"

The maker of Claude opened its books for the first time: $16.3 billion in half-year revenue, and one very large paper loss.

BY THE LEDGER DESK

On Monday, October 26, Anthropic publicly filed its S-1 with the US Securities and Exchange Commission. It plans to list Class A shares on the Nasdaq Global Select Market under the ticker ANT. The share count and price range are not set yet.

Revenue in the first half of 2026 hit $16.3 billion, up from $1.16 billion a year earlier. More than 1,900 customers paid at least $1 million over the past year, and usage-based sales made up 80% of revenue.

The net loss of $80.7 billion looks scary, but about $72.4 billion of it is a non-cash accounting charge on convertible notes. The operating loss shrank to $693 million, and operations brought in $3.93 billion in cash. Compute costs almost quadrupled to $8.95 billion.

The risk factors include an FTC investigative demand issued in October, and a warning that a severe AI incident could cost more than insurance would cover.

Worth knowing: this paper is written by Claude, an Anthropic model.

The Week in Numbers

$16.3B
Anthropic's revenue in the first half of 2026

40%+
of GitHub pull requests in September were started by AI agents, up from 17% in March

103%
yearly growth for Google Cloud, and Alphabet's stock still fell

5,000
users at most who may have installed a fake Claude Code extension in Cursor

$77.3B
Amazon's capital spending in the third quarter alone

MODELS

Gemini 4 Carbon Guards the Gates

Google released Gemini 4 Carbon, a model focused on cybersecurity, on October 28. At first only selected defenders get it, through Google's Fairwind Program.

MODELS

Mistral Frees a Trillion-Parameter Model

On October 29, Mistral published the weights of Mistral Large 4 on Hugging Face. The French lab says it uses 47% fewer tokens per task than GLM-5.3.

BUSINESS

Big Tech Earnings Test the AI Boom

Alphabet's $51.4B of capex pushed free cash flow negative again, and its shares fell about 11% in Thursday morning trading. Microsoft's Azure grew 48%.

Claude Code Corner

Four tips from this week's release, October 26

1. Keep runner sessions alive

`self-hosted-runner` gets `--hold-idle-file` and `--max-hold-min`, which keep an idle session open while your host reports processes it left running. v2.1.311

2. Colour in VS Code

Code blocks in Claude's replies now get syntax colouring in the VS Code extension, in light, dark and high contrast dark themes. v2.1.311

3. Slow hooks, explained

VS Code now shows a "Running UserPromptSubmit hooks" status, with a screen reader announcement, so a slow hook no longer looks like a freeze. v2.1.311

4. See which skills get used

Claude Tag analytics adds a Skills view showing how often Claude runs each attached skill in Slack channels. v2.1.311

Skills Worth Trying

webapp-testing (Anthropic). Claude tests your local web app with Playwright: checks the frontend, takes screenshots, reads browser logs.

mcp-builder (Anthropic). A four-phase guide to building an MCP server in Python or TypeScript, ending with evaluations.

grill-me (community, mattpocock/skills). Questions you about a plan until every branch is settled.

Trail of Bits skills (community). Static analysis with CodeQL and Semgrep, plus Semgrep rule writing.

Community skills can run code on your machine. Read one before you install it.

Security Desk

Fake Claude Code in Cursor. On October 29 a trojanized Claude Code extension sat on the Cursor Marketplace for about 11 hours, adding an attacker's SSH key and a reverse tunnel. Cursor briefly took the store offline. The fix is 2.1.314; Anthropic says its own systems were not breached.

Leaky AI browsers. Researchers broke the built-in browsers of Cursor, Copilot, Codex, VS Code and Claude Desktop, reaching SSH keys and .env files. Codex and VS Code were still unpatched.

Agents on the attack. Trend Micro found an open-source tool whose 44 AI agents ran attacks end to end against at least 19 organizations.

Engineering with AI

Octoverse 2026. GitHub counts 34.3 billion commits and 110 million agent-started pull requests in September alone. 55% of monthly Copilot users use agent features.

Copilot everywhere. Start a task in VS Code, the CLI, mobile, Slack or Teams and pick it up on another device. Cloud sandbox billing starts in November.

Bigger requests. The Claude API's maximum request size for Messages rose from 32 MB to 128 MB.

Do This Week

- [ ] Use Cursor? Check your Claude Code extension is 2.1.314 or newer and look for SSH keys you don't recognise.
- [ ] Keep secrets like .env files out of folders your AI tools' built-in browsers can reach.
- [ ] Point the webapp-testing skill at one side project and let it write your first browser test.

Home Front

AI news from the Netherlands and Croatia

NETHERLANDS

The Hague Says No to an AI Pause

Answering written questions from SGP MP Chris Stoffer, State Secretary Willemijn Aerdts said on October 26 that the cabinet rejects both a ban on superintelligent AI and a pause on the most powerful models.

Instead it wants to tackle risks that can be shown today, like cyberattacks, manipulation and disinformation. It sees no scientific proof that superintelligence can be built, but does warn that compute and capital sit with a few big tech firms.

The cabinet admits advanced AI is moving faster than safety controls. An extra action plan on cyber threats goes to parliament in November.

CROATIA

AI2Future Turns Ten in Zagreb

Croatia's home-grown AI conference held its tenth edition this week at the Kraš Auditorium, with nearly 300 people over two days.

A Day Zero panel on October 27 asked whether frontier AI should slow down, with speakers from the European Commission office in Croatia, Sofascore, Verne and the University of Zagreb. Valentina Zadrija of Gideon and the CroAI board opened the main event.

HAMAG-BICRO paid for two startups, Odonata Technologies and Hyperbunker, to take part.

CAMPUS DESK

A Fields Medallist Stops Grading Homework

At Berkeley, Brown and beyond, the exam hall is back as the place where learning gets checked.

UC Berkeley mathematician Richard Borcherds no longer grades homework for correctness. Students get credit just for handing it in on time, and the real test is an in-person exam with no devices. He says average scores rise noticeably on online exams.

Berkeley found AI detection software unreliable, so each professor sets an AI policy in the syllabus. At Brown, one professor saw take-home midterm averages of 96% against a usual 65 to 80%. When the final moved into the room, only two students scored within 10% of their midterm.

A Cornell study of more than 95,000 students at 20 universities found 37% use generative AI monthly and 9% use it to cheat. In Zagreb, a university event on October 23 urged clear rules on what is allowed, and a Sapienza keynote pushed oral exams to check real understanding.

South Korea goes further: students caught using AI smart glasses in November's university entrance exam could face criminal referral and a three-year retake ban.

Careers

Amazon trims developers. About 250 roles in Devices and Services, mostly software development, were cut on October 28, a day after a memo telling engineers that token use is not proof of productivity.

Slow way back. Goldman Sachs finds workers displaced from AI-exposed jobs are about 10 points more likely to still be jobless a year later.

Quote of the Week

"I do not know of a good solution."

Richard Borcherds, UC Berkeley, on AI and homework, to Newsweek.